

Michael Mwanza

Fullstack & AI Engineer | Laravel, React, Next.js | Remote, Harare, Zimbabwe

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CORE SKILLS

- Languages**
PHP, JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, SQL
- Frontend**
React, Next.js, Inertia.js, Tailwind CSS
- Backend**
Laravel, Node.js, Express, REST APIs
- Realtime**
WebSockets (Reverb), WebRTC
- Data**
PostgreSQL, MySQL, Prisma, Redis, Supabase
- AI**
RAG pipelines, multimodal vision, Gemini, Grok
- DevOps**
GitHub Actions, Docker, Nginx, CI/CD

EDUCATION

- BSc, Software Development**
BYU-Idaho, 2026
- Associate Degree, Software Development**
BYU-Idaho, 2025

CERTIFICATIONS

- Backend Development Certificate**
ALX Africa, 2025
- Software Engineering Programme**
ALX Africa, 2023

LANGUAGES

- English (Native)
Shona (Native)

LIVE WORK

- michaelmwanza.site
alignedsurveyors.co.zw
summitguesthouse.org
zamsam.org
mompop.online
handcrafted-haven-pied.vercel.app
pokedex-version-2.netlify.app

OPEN TO

Remote roles with global teams, Laravel and AI-focused product work, startups.

PROFILE

Fullstack and AI engineer with 3+ years delivering production applications end to end, from database design to deployment. Specialises in offline-first systems, secure payment flows, realtime collaboration and RAG-powered assistants that answer from live business data. Currently open to remote roles on Laravel and AI-focused product teams.

EXPERIENCE

- Independent Contractor, Fullstack & AI Engineer** Apr 2023 to Present
- Built RAG pipelines that query live business data, replacing routine customer-support questions and turning product discovery into natural-language conversation.
 - Delivered 3 client platforms plus a self-built SaaS product (Mom & Pop POS), specialising in offline-first systems, secure payment flows and AI features.
 - Architected products end to end: database design, REST APIs, React and Next.js frontends, CI/CD, and Docker/Nginx deployment.
 - Automated live updates and testing with GitHub Actions CI/CD pipelines.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- Mom & Pop POS** 2026 to Present
Self-built SaaS | Laravel, React, Inertia, Dexie.js, PostgreSQL, Redis
Problem. Small shops, bars and restaurants in Zimbabwe lose sales whenever the network drops, and struggle to reconcile cash and staff at the end of a shift.
Solution. An offline-first, multi-tenant POS that keeps processing sales without a connection, then syncs at cash-up. Includes a five-tier role hierarchy, shift-based variance auditing, printable staff slips, subscription licensing, and a Redis to PostgreSQL to Supabase backup pipeline. Preparing for beta launch.
- Aligned Surveyors ERP & CRM** 2026 to Present
Client platform | Laravel 12, React, Inertia, Reverb, WebRTC
Problem. Staff, clients and project data sit in disconnected tools, and answering a simple business question means digging through records by hand.
Solution. One live platform with realtime collaborative chat, secure peer-to-peer video conferencing, and a database-aware AI analytics layer that answers questions from the company's own data.
- Summit Guesthouse Platform** 2023 to 2026
Client platform | Rebuilt from Next.js | Laravel, React, Inertia, TypeScript, PostgreSQL
Problem. Manual bookings meant guests could only reserve and pay during office hours, and availability across channels had to be tracked by hand.
Solution. A 24/7 automated storefront with multi-room cart bookings and end-to-end PayNow payments (secure initiation, async webhook confirmation). Two-way Booking.com iCal sync, staff roles, walk-in bookings, and an AI chatbot that checks live availability.
- Zamsam Engineering Platform** 2024 to 2026
Client platform | Rebuilt from Next.js | Laravel, React, Inertia, WhatsApp automation
Problem. A refrigeration, AC and electrical contractor was fielding unqualified enquiries slowly, with no clear route from website visit to the right person.
Solution. A marketing platform with a RAG-powered AI assistant that qualifies inbound leads, plus an automated WhatsApp routing pipeline and one-tap WhatsApp, call and email calls to action.
- Handcrafted Haven, AI Marketplace** 2025 to 2026
Marketplace | Next.js frontend, Node.js + Express backend | PostgreSQL, Prisma | Gemini RAG
Problem. Keyword search fails shoppers who describe what they want loosely, so they miss products that are actually in the catalogue.
Solution. A decoupled marketplace (university team project, extended by me after graduation) with a Gemini RAG assistant that answers live catalogue questions and reasons up to related categories when a query is inexact, such as suggesting cutting boards when no knives are stocked.
- Pokédex AI, Multimodal Vision Pipeline** 2026 to Present
Personal project | Next.js (serverless on Netlify), Prisma, Supabase | Gemini Vision, voice output
Problem. Identifying something from a camera feed is slow and costly if every look-up calls a vision model from scratch.
Solution. Point the camera at a Pokémon and Gemini identifies its stats and types, spoken back by voice. A self-augmenting cache serves repeat identifications without another model call.